

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

We loved our childhood home!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What type of place did you grow up in?
- What are some of your fondest memories of your childhood there?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can express an unfulfilled action or wish in the past.
- I can talk about unreal past situations.





Let's Explore!

The boys had always been **close*** as children.

* When people are "close" they know each other extremely well.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Edward and Robert Harmer grew up in the house on Cranberry Lane. Their great-grandfather had built the house in 1850. This was the house their grandfather and their father had been born in as well. For them it was the house that had held all their memories until they left.

There was never a dull moment in the Harmer household, if the truth were to have been told. The boys had always been close as children. If they were to have fought, they always made up quickly. If anyone were to have described them, they would have said they were inseparable. The energetic brothers spent their summers running around together barefoot. After they had gone fishing in the local river, pretending they were fly-fishing experts, they had often come back empty-handed but happy. When they had found a new secret hiding place in the area where no one could find them, they had disappeared for hours. They often really needed hiding places too, because they were constantly in trouble, much to the dismay of their parents.

If they were to have accidentally thrown a football through a neighbor's window, or happened to have poured bleach onto Mrs. Jones' prized rose bushes, or were to have slathered shaving cream all over Uncle Bart's car, they would have been in trouble. Somehow they had always managed to get away with murder.

Everything had changed when they got older. Both were sure they would have more time to spend together, but they did not. They were busy living their own lives, and the house on Cranberry Lane grew quiet. Edward and Robert had tried to visit often, but as time went on, their lives became more hectic and time seemed to evaporate.

After their mother had passed away, they tried to convince their father to move closer to one of them, but he refused. In only a few short months, Thomas Harmer died in his sleep in the great big bed that he was born in. That was when trouble began.





Let's Practice!

Things changed when they got older.

Instructions: Circle the correct option to correctly complete the sentences.

- For them it was the house that _____ all their memories until they left.
a. had held b. have hold c. was held
- After they _____ fishing in the local river, pretending they were fly-fishing experts, they had often come back empty-handed but happy.
a. had gone b. have went c. are going
- When they had found new secret hiding places in the area where no one could find them, they _____ for hours.
a. have disappearing b. had disappear c. had disappeared
- Edward and Robert _____ to visit often, but as time went on, their lives became more hectic and time seemed to evaporate.
a. had tried b. are tried c. have trying
- After their mother had passed away they _____ to convince their father to move closer to one of them, but he refused.
a. have trying b. are tried c. tried



Let's Practice!

The brothers are no longer close to each other as they had hoped to be.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. When you complete the sentences, read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

- There was never a dull moment in the Harmer household, if
- If they were to have fought,
- If anyone were to have described them,
- If they were to have accidentally thrown a football through a neighbor's windows,
- If things stayed the same,

COLUMN B

- they would have been in trouble.
- they always made up quickly.
- they would have said they were inseparable.
- they would have been more close to each other.
- the truth were to have been told.





Extension Activity

Talk about a childhood home.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find a picture on the Internet or in a magazine of a house with a yard that looks interesting.
- Describe the house and the area around it.
- Imagine that you lived in that house and area as a child and say what you and a friend or sibling did with your free time there.
- Explain what you liked about the area and house.
- Write about 200 words in total.
- Use sentences that express an unfulfilled action or wish in the past.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I choose a picture of a house and describe it and the area around it.

☐ ☐

I write an imaginary account of what a friend or sibling and I did in the house and area.

☐ ☐

I use the Past Simple and the Past perfect.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to make up** (verb): to forgive someone after an argument or disagreement
e.g. If they were to have fought, they always made up quickly.
- **never a dull moment** (expression): something is always changing or happening
e.g. There was never a dull moment in the Harmer household.
- **inseparable** (adjective): always together
e.g. They would have said they were inseparable.
- **barefoot** (adjective): without shoes or socks
e.g. The energetic brothers spent their summers running around together barefoot.
- **fly-fishing** (noun): the sport of fishing using a rod and an artificial fly as bait
e.g. They had gone fishing in the local river, pretending they were fly-fishing experts.
- **prized** (adjective): highly valued
e.g. They happened to have poured bleach onto Mrs. Jones' prized rose bushes.
- **to slather** (verb): to spread
e.g. They were found to have slathered shaving cream all over Uncle Bart's car.
- **to get away with murder** (expression): succeed in doing whatever one chooses without being punished or suffering any disadvantage
e.g. Somehow they had always managed to get away with murder.



Learning Points

Past Perfect for Unfulfilled Action

The Past Perfect tense is in reality, the past of the past. You use it to say that an action was completed before another action took place. Both the actions are related to each other in some way. The action already completed is expressed by the Past Perfect tense. The action which takes place later is expressed by the Simple Past tense.

You can use the Past Perfect to talk about unfulfilled actions in the past.

For example:

*If I **had worked** harder, I would have been promoted.*

The Past Perfect construction is part of the third conditional - which refers to an unreal situation in the past.

Here's another example:

*John **had hoped** to get a promotion, but he didn't work hard enough.*

Examples:

- *For them it was the house that had held all their memories until they left.*
- *After they had gone fishing in the local river, pretending they were fly-fishing experts, they had often come back empty-handed but happy.*
- *When they had found new secret hiding places in the area where no one could find them, they had disappeared for hours.*
- *Edward and Robert had tried to visit often, but as time went on, their lives became more hectic and time seemed to evaporate.*
- *After their mother had passed away, they tried to convince their father to move closer to one of them, but he refused.*





Learning Points

Perfect Infinitives for Unreal Past

You use Perfect Infinitives in the same way as you use other Perfect tenses (to talk about the past). You can use them to talk about unreal situations in the past.

For example:

*If you **were to have asked**, I would have helped.* (You didn't ask and I didn't help.)

*He **was meant to have asked** my permission before using my computer.* (He did not ask my permission.)

*If she **were to have become** a nurse, she could work here with us.* (She has not become a nurse.)

*He **would like to have sent** her flowers.* (He didn't send flowers but he wanted to.)

You need to be aware of the context when using modals in this way since some of them can also be used to talk about probability and certainty.

For example:

*She **could have/should have arrived** by now.*

Examples:

- *There was never a dull moment in the Harmer household if the truth were to have been told.*
- *If they were to have fought, they always made up quickly.*
- *If anyone were to have described them, they would have said they were inseparable*
- *If they were to have accidentally thrown a football through a neighbor's windows, or happened to have poured bleach onto Mrs. Jones' prized rose bushes, or were found to have slathered shaving cream all over Uncle Bart's car, they would have been in trouble.*

